MIL-S-37392A
8 August 1986
SUPERSEDING
MIL-S-37392 (DSA-DM)
11 December 1975

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

SPECULUM, VAGINAL, PLASTIC

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers one type of disposable, adjustable vaginal speculum suitable for use in gynecological procedures.

1.2 Classification. Vaginal speculums shall be furnished in the following sizes as specified (see 6.2):

Size		Blade length (in inches)
Small	-	3-5/8
Medium	-	4
Large	-	5

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Headquarters, Defense Personnel Support Center, ATTN: Directorate of Medical Materiel, DPSC-ATT, 2800 S. 20th Street, Philadelphia, PA 19101, by using self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 6515
DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T10:36Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

2.1.1 Specifications and standards. The following specifications and standards form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents shall be those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DoDISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping Fiberboard.

MILITARY

MIL-P-116 - Preservation-Packaging, Methods of.

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.
MIL-STD-147 - Palletized Unit Loads.
MIL-STD-794 - Parts and Equipment, Procedures for Packaging of.

2.1.2 Drawing. The following drawing forms a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issue shall be that in effect on the date of the solicitation.

DRAWING

Defense Personnel Support Center (DPSC)

No. 24366 - Speculum, Vaginal, Small, Medium and Large

(Copies of specifications, standards and drawing required by contractors in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting activity.)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T10:36Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

2.2 Other publication. The following document forms a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issue of the document which is DoD adopted shall be that listed in the issue of the DoDISS specified in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issue of document not listed in the DoDISS shall be the issue of the nongovernment document which is current on the date of the solicitation.

U. S. PHARMACOPEIAL CONVENTION, INC.

PHARMACOPEIA OF THE UNITED STATES (U.S.P.)

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Mack Publishing Company, Easton, PA 18042)

(Nongovernment standards and other publications are normally available from the organizations which prepare or which distribute the documents. These documents also may be available in or through libraries or other informational services).

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this specification and the references cited herein, the text of this specification shall take precedence. Nothing in this specification, however, shall supersede applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. The vaginal speculum shall be fabricated from suitable clear, rigid, plastic material as a minimum. The outer surface of the speculum blades shall be coated with a thin layer of silicone lubricant.

3.2 Style, design and dimensions. The vaginal speculum shall be designed to permit the examining physician to adjust to and hold any one of six positions. The unit shall be designed for one hand operation and shall be siliconized for increased lubricity. Shall be in accordance with DPSC Drawing No. 24366. The manufacturer shall supply instructions for use with each unit package.

3.3 Breakage. The speculum shall not crack, break, or unlock at any point on this item when tested as specified in 4.5.2.

3.4 Biological test. Shall be found biologically suitable when tested as specified in 4.5.1.

3.5 Identification marking. Each vaginal speculum shall clearly and legibly bear the manufacturer's name or registered trademark.

3.6 Workmanship. Workmanship shall be first class throughout. The vaginal speculum shall show a smooth finished outer surface free from pits, flash, scale and holes. All edges shall be smooth.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 20260-21T10:36Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of 3 years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

4.1.2 Inspection. Inspection, as used in this specification, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

4.1.3 Certificates of quality. Certificates of quality, supplied by the manufacturer of the plastic may be furnished in lieu of actual performance of such testing by the contractor, provided lot identity has been maintained and can be demonstrated to the Government. The certificate shall include the name of the contractor, the contract number, the name of the manufacturer or supplier, the National Stock Number (NSN), the item identification, the name of the component/material, the lot number, the lot size, the sample size, the date of testing, the test method, individual test results, and the specification requirements.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 For examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as indicated in table I. The unit of product for examination purposes shall be one vaginal speculum.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T10:36Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE I. Sampling criteria for examination

Type of defect	Inspection level	AQL (percent defective)
Major	S-2	1.0
Minor	S-1	1.5

4.2.2 For tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as indicated in table II. The unit of product for test purpose shall be one vaginal speculum. Where feasible, the same sample unit shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

TABLE II. Sampling criteria for tests

Component	Characteristic	Requirement	Test procedure	Inspection level	AQL percent defective
1-Speculum	Material Class II	3.1	4.5.1	1/	2/
	Dimensions	3.2	-----	S-2	1.0
	Breaking test	3.3	4.5.2	S-1	1.0

1/ Each lot of product need not be biologically tested provided evidence is furnished that samples for the formulation and identical method of processing had previously been tested that they comply with USP requirements for Class II plastics and that they are the same as being offered on this contract.

2/ Acceptance number shall be zero.

4.2.3 Raw materials. Sufficient quantity of each lot of plastic used in the construction of the vaginal speculum shall be selected for chemical analysis.

4.3. Examination. The vaginal speculum shall be examined to determine compliance with all the requirements contained in this specification. Examination shall be conducted as specified in tables I and III. Examination, however, shall not be restricted to defects listed in table III. Any vaginal speculum in the sample containing one or more defects shall be rejected. If the number of defective devices in any sample exceeds the acceptance number for the sample, the lot represented by that sample shall be rejected.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T10:36Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE III. Classification of defects

Categories	Defects
Critical	None defined
Major	
101	One or more components missing.
102	Blades and handles not free of cracks, burrs, and slivers.
103	Surfaces of blades and handles not smoothly finished, and not free of flash, and feathering.
104	Speculum not easily opened, closed and locked when operated in accordance with oopperating instructions.
Minor	
201	Operating instructions not supplied with each unit package.

4.4 Inspection of packaging. The inspection of the preservation-packaging and interior package marking shall be in accordance with the group A and B quality conformance inspection requirements of MIL-P-116. The inspection of the packing and marking for shipment and storage shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of the applicable container specification and the marking requirements of MIL-STD-129.

4.5 Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements.

4.5.1 Biological tests for Class II plastic. The vaginal speculum shall be tested in accordance with the requirements of the USP for Class II plastic.

4.5.2 Breaking test for lock and blades. Open and lock the speculum blades in the fully open position. Support the bottom blade securely on a flat, firm surface and gradually apply a force to the upper blade 1/2 + 1/8 inch from the distal end. For the small speculum, apply a weight of 8.0 pounds, the medium speculum, 7.0 pounds, for the large speculum, 6.0 pounds.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-21T10:36Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation. Preservation shall be level A or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Cleaning and drying. Each speculum shall be cleaned and dried in accordance with MIL-P-116.

5.1.1.2 Preservative applications. Preservatives shall not be used.

5.1.1.3 Unit package. Ten or 25 speculums of one size only shall be packaged in a suitable bag constructed of polyethylene film or of double wall kraft paper. Closure of bag shall be adequate to prevent spilling of contents during shipment and handling. Ten bags containing 10 speculums or four bags containing 25 speculums of one size only shall be further packaged in a box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. Closure shall be as specified in the box specification.

5.1.2 Level C. The level C preservation for speculum shall conform to the MIL-STD-794 requirements for this level.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or C as specified (see 6.2.)

5.2.1 Level A. Speculums packaged as specified in 5.1.1.3 shall require no further packing except that the box shall conform to PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant. Closure, strapping and waterproofing shall be as specified in the box specification.

5.2.2 Level B. Speculums packaged as specified in 5.1.1.3 shall require no further packing.

5.2.3 Level C. The level C packing for speculums shall conform to the MIL-STD-794 requirements for this level.

5.2.4 Packing variation permitted. If the required number of units to be shipped is less than the number of units specified to be overpacked in a exterior container, such units shall be packed in an exterior container of suitable size and design, acceptable to a common carrier, which will insure safe delivery to destination.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T10:36Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5.2.5 Unitized loads. Unitized loads, commensurate with the level of packing specified in the contract or order, shall be used whenever total quantities for shipment to one destination equal 40 cubic feet or more. Loads shall be unitized on pallets conforming to MIL-STD-147. Quantities less than 40 cubic feet need not be unitized. Pallet loads including the pallet shall not exceed 43 inches in height, 48 inches in width, and 40 inches in length. Pallet and shall conform to Type IV or Type V.

5.2.5.1 Levels A and B. Speculums packed as specified in 5.2.1 and 5.2.2 shall be unitized on pallets as specified in 5.2.5.

5.2.5.2 Level C. Speculums packed as specified in 5.2.3 shall be unitized as specified in MIL-STD-794.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Levels A, B and C. Each exterior container and unitized load shall be marked as specified in MIL-STD-129.

5.4 General.

5.4.1 Exterior container. Exterior container (see 5.2.1, 5.2.2, and 5.2.3) shall be of minimum tare and cube consistent with the protection required and shall contain equal quantities of identical stock numbered items to the greatest extent practicable.

5.4.2 Packaging inspection. The inspection of these packaging requirements shall be in accordance with 4.4.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The vaginal speculum is intended for use in gynecological procedures.

6.2 Ordering data. Contractors should exercise any desired options specified herein, and the acquisition documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of specification.
(b) Classification (see 1.2).
(c) Applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2)
(d) National Stock Number.

6.3 National Stock Number coverage. This specification covers the following National Stock Number:

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-21T10:36Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

National Stock No.	Item Identification	Size
6515-00-149-1606	SPECULUM, VAGINAL, Plastic, Large, Disposable, 5 Inch Blade, 100s	Large
6515-00-149-1607	SPECULUM, VAGINAL, Plastic, Small, Disposable, 3-5/8 Inch Blade, 100s	Small
6515-00-914-1543	SPECULUM, VAGINAL, Plastic, Medium, Disposable, 4 Inch Blade, 100s	Medium

It does not include all types or sizes as indicated by the title nor all types which are commercially available.

6.4 Subject term (key word) listing.

Disposable
Plastic
Speculum
Vaginal

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing Activity:

DoD-MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

Project No. 6515-3461

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-21T10:36Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T10:36Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

INSTRUCTIONS: In a continuing effort to make our standardization documents better, the DoD provides this form for use in submitting comments and suggestions for improvements. All users of military standardization documents are invited to provide suggestions. This form may be detached, folded along the lines indicated, taped along the loose edge *(DO NOT STAPLE)*, and mailed. In block 5, be as specific as possible about particular problem areas such as wording which required interpretation, was too rigid, restrictive, loose, ambiguous, or was incompatible, and give proposed wording changes which would alleviate the problems. Enter in block 6 any remarks not related to a specific paragraph of the document. If block 7 is filled out, an acknowledgement will be mailed to you within 30 days to let you know that your comments were received and are being considered.

NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document*(s)* or to amend contractual requirements.

(Fold along this line)

(Fold along this line)

OFFICIAL BUSINESS
PENALTY FOR PRIVATE USE $300

BUSINESS REPLY MAIL
FIRST CLASS PERMIT NO. 3966 Alexandria, VA

POSTAGE WILL BE PAID BY

Commander
Defense Personnel Support Center
ATTN: DPSC-RST
2800 South 20th St.
Philadelphia, PA 19101

NO POSTAGE
NECESSARY
IF MAILED
IN THE
UNITED STATES

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T10:36Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

(TO DETACH THIS FORM, CUT ALONG THIS LINE.)

STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions -- Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-S-37392A	SPECULUM, VAGINAL, PLASTIC

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR ☐ USER ☐ MANUFACTURER ☐ OTHER *(Specify)* _____
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording

b. Recommended Wording

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

DD FORM 82 MAR 1426 PREVIOUS EDITION IS OBSOLETE

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-21T10:36Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.